

The Pharhad Road

Color manual and player reference

A road-by-road tactics game about keeping the heroes alive, waking the right fights, and using Pharhad's shrine and camp before the next clash.

Teymurian Studios

Vanguard

Wayfinder

Ember Sage

Becky

Quick Start

The short path from menu to road victory

1. Pick a mode

Every mode now goes to a second screen. Choose the road, read the mode text, then press Start Game.

2. Take turns

On your turn, select a skill, pick a legal target, move, or end turn. The game log shows the player hint when you control that turn.

3. Clear encounters

After each encounter, recover before walking into the next group. Dead heroes need Pharhad Idol first; wounded heroes want Safe Camp.

4. Finish the roads

Road 1 leads to Road 2, then Road 3, then Road 4 when the heroes survive. If Game Over appears and a save exists, choose Restart From Save to resume the last autosave.

Autosave loop: finish an encounter -> recover -> autosave -> restart from that save after Game Over if needed.

Menu And Modes

All modes use a road/setup screen before Start Game

Play Heroes

Normal party control. Pick Road 1-4, then lead Vanguard, Wayfinder, Ember Sage, and Becky.

Play Monsters

Like Play Heroes, except you control the active monster turns. No monster-picking step. Flesh Beasts stay AI-only.

Play Pharhad / Send Cleric Z

Play Pharhad gives divine intervention turns. The gold Send Cleric Z button opens its own setup screen for a solo run with Love and Truth.

Hero Chess

A tactical duel against rival heroes. Fog is off, player units glow blue, enemy units glow red, and rivals carry one Salve Vial.

Menu buttons: Music, Fog, 11s, Tutorial, Email Me, Rename. 11s has no color when off, turns red when on, and is disabled in Tutorial.

Controls And UI

Where to look during play

Turn Queue

Top row shows who acts next. The active icon has the large glowing box. Hero Chess uses blue player markers and red enemy markers; Cleric Z allies glow green.

Game Log

Skill selections write full explanations here, including cost, range, dice, saves, and special effects.

Stats Popup

Click or tap icons to inspect units, items, and map features. The popup opens at the top-left with a darker background.

Target Highlights

During player-controlled turns, legal enemy targets are highlighted orange. Converted Cleric Z allies stay visually separate from monsters with green glow markers.

Fog

Fog can be toggled from the menu. Play Monsters and Hero Chess run with fog off; Truth still respects line of sight and cannot pass through walls.

Menu Pause

Opening the game menu pauses game activity and blocks status icon clicks while music keeps playing.

11s Mode

Fast turns with sound cues and a visible clock

11s

When enabled, the player has 11 seconds to choose a turn. The last 3 seconds play the button sound, and the timer hitting 0 plays the turn-advance cue.

Actions finish

The timer advances the turn after the time limit, but it still lets actions already started finish cleanly.

Tutorial lockout

Tutorial disables 11s mode so new players can read, inspect, and learn without pressure.

Clock location

The clock-like timer sits under the player turn queue icon so it is visible without covering the board.

Menu colors

11s turns red when active. When it is off, the button has no special color so it reads like a normal inactive menu option.

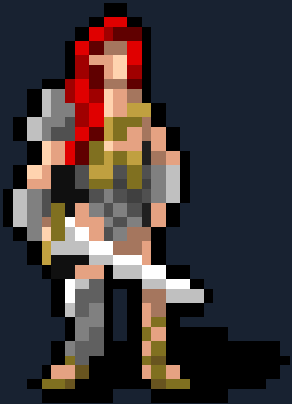
Use 11s after you already know the icons. It turns the game into a quick-read tactics drill.

Hero Party

The four playable heroes

Vanguard

HP 14 | Move 6 | Guard 17
Attack +5 | Damage +7 | Init +2
STR 16 DEX 14 CON 15 WIS 10



Wayfinder

HP 14 | Move 7 | Guard 14
Attack +4 | Damage +2 | Init +2
STR 12 DEX 15 CON 14 WIS 16



Ember Sage

HP 9 | Move 6 | Guard 14
Attack +4 | Damage +1 | Init +0
STR 10 DEX 12 CON 16 WIS 14



Becky

HP 14 | Move 9 | Guard 14
Attack +4 | Damage +2 | Init +6
STR 12 DEX 20 CON 14 WIS 16



Rename keeps the roles clear: Vanguard, Wayfinder, Ember Sage, and Becky remain the four hero slots.

Hero Skill Playbook

What the party is built to do

Vanguard



Steel Brand: Cost: Action. Range: 1-1 ft. Roll: 1d8 Slashing.
Grit Mend: Bonus: Heal 1d10 +2 Cost: Bonus Action.
Tempo Break: Free Action: Take one additional Attack action this turn. 1 per Food. Cost: Free.
Spear: Cost: Action. Range: 0-4 ft. Roll: 1d6 Piercing.

Wayfinder



Trail Bow: Slow: -10 ft movement Cost: Action. Range: 2-30 ft. Roll: 1d8 Slashing.
Quarry Brand: Bonus Action: Mark one enemy in range. Deal +1d6 Force on every hit against the...
Food: The party eats food between encounters. Vanguard regains 1 Grit Mend, Tempo Bre...
Auto Move: Cost: Free.

Ember Sage



Ember Shot: Cost: Action. Range: 2-24 ft. Roll: 1d10 Slashing.
Homing Sparks: Cost: Action. Range: 1-24 ft. Roll: 3d4+3 Psychic.
Inner Flare: Cost: Bonus Action.
Field Mend: Touch to Heal 2d8 + Wis [1 focus] Cost: Action. Range: 1-1 ft.

Becky



Two Kicks: ADV next attack Cost: Action. Range: 1-2 ft. Roll: 1d6+4 Bludgeoning. Save: Dex...
Spear: Cost: Action. Range: 0-4 ft. Roll: 1d6 Piercing.
Tempo Break: Free Action: Take one additional Attack action this turn. 1 per Food. Cost: Free.
Field Mend: Touch to Heal 2d8 + Wis [1 focus] Cost: Action. Range: 1-1 ft.

Enemies And Rivals

What fights back



Thistlekin Scout

Basic road fighter. Numbers matter more than one big hit.

HP 7 | Move 6 | Guard 15



Thistlekin Captain

Captain pressure piece. Watch clustering and focus fire.

HP 21 | Move 6 | Guard 17



Thistlekin General

Now the Thistlekin General. Stronger road leader.

HP 21 | Move 6 | Guard 17



Flesh Beast

Renamed Flesh Beast. AI-only in Play Monsters.

HP 11 | Move 8 | Guard 13



Cave Brute

Heavy hitter with high HP and guard.

HP 27 | Move 6 | Guard 16



Pharhad

Powerful protector in Play Pharhad mode.

HP 110 | Move 30 | Guard 30

Hero Chess marks players blue and enemies red on the map and turn queue. Cleric Z converts enemies into allies with glowing green markers.

Items And Map Features

Pickups and recovery points



Spear

Cost: Action. Range: 0-4 ft. Roll: 1d6 Piercing.



Food

The party eats food between encounters. Vanguard regains 1 Grit Mend, Tempo Break refreshes, Ember Sage and Wayfinder regain 1 focus charge. Cost: Free.



Safe Camp

The party makes a safe camp. All resources fully restored and HP fully healed. Cost: Free.



Pharhad Idol

Stand next to the idol between encounters to bring every dead hero back to life. Cost: Free.



Salve Vial

2d4+2 Salve Vial Cost: Action.

Post-encounter hint: revive dead heroes at Pharhad Idol first, then use Safe Camp to restore skills and health.

Skill Encyclopedia 1

Attack and pressure skills



Steel Brand

Cost: Action. Range: 1-1 ft. Roll: 1d8 Slashing.



Quick Blade

Vex: ADV next attack. Cost: Action. Range: 1-1 ft. Roll: 1d6 Slashing.



Cleaver Strike

Graze: damage on miss Cost: Action. Range: 1-1 ft. Roll: 2d6 Slashing.



Curved Blade

Cost: Action. Range: 1-1 ft. Roll: 1d6 Slashing.



Iron Maul

Cost: Action. Roll: 2d8 Piercing.



Trail Bow

Slow: -10 ft movement Cost: Action. Range: 2-30 ft. Roll: 1d8 Slashing.



Skirmish Bow

Cost: Action. Range: 2-16 ft. Roll: 1d6 Slashing.



Bolt Launcher

Push: 10 ft Cost: Action. Range: 2-20 ft. Roll: 1d10 Slashing.



Spear

Cost: Action. Range: 0-4 ft. Roll: 1d6 Piercing.



Two Kicks

ADV next attack Cost: Action. Range: 1-2 ft. Roll: 1d6+4 Bludgeoning. Save: Dexterity DC 19; fail: prone.

Skill Encyclopedia 2

Support, movement, and recovery



Dash

Extra movement Cost: Action.



Auto Move

Cost: Free.



Grit Mend

Bonus: Heal 1d10 +2 Cost: Bonus Action.



Salve Vial

2d4+2 Salve Vial Cost: Action.



Safe Camp

The party makes a safe camp. All resources fully restored and HP fully healed. Cost: Free.



Disengage

Do not provoke opportunity attacks Cost: Action.



Help

Touch to stabilize Cost: Action. Range: 1-1 ft.



Field Mend

Touch to Heal 2d8 + Wis [1 focus] Cost: Action. Range: 1-1 ft.



Food

The party eats food between encounters. Vanguard regains 1 Grit Mend, Tempo Break refreshes, Ember Sage and Wayfinder regain 1 focus charge. Cost: Free.

Skill Encyclopedia 3

Magic, Pharhad, Cleric Z, and special effects



Ember Shot

Cost: Action. Range: 2-24 ft. Roll: 1d10 Slashing.



Inner Flare

Cost: Bonus Action.



Love

Melee touch. On contact, the target becomes your ally.



Divine Restore

Cost: Free. Range: 0-120 ft. Target: Sphere area, radius 30 ft.



Tempo Break

Free Action: Take one additional Attack action this turn. 1 per Food. Cost: Free.



Homing Sparks

Cost: Action. Range: 1-24 ft. Roll: 3d4+3 Psychic.



Quarry Brand

Bonus Action: Mark one enemy in range. Deal +1d6 Force on every hit against them. Concentration, up to 1 hour. 2 free casts per Safe Camp.
Cost: Bonus Action. Range: 2-90 ft.



Truth

Range 4 tiles, line of sight. Visible enemies in radius make Wisdom DC 19 saves; failures become allies.



Pharhad Idol

Stand next to the idol between encounters to bring every dead hero back to life. Cost: Free.



Flesh Beast Bite

Cost: Action. Range: 1-1 ft. Roll: 2d6 Slashing. Save: Strength DC 11; fail: prone.

Image Atlas 2

Skill icons



Auto Move



Bolt Launcher



Cleaver Strike



Curved Blade



Dash



Disengage



Divine Restore



Ember Shot



Flesh Beast Bite



Food



Field Mend



Two Kicks



Grit Mend



Help



Homing Sparks



Inner Flare



Iron Maul



Steel Brand



Pharhad Idol



Quarry Brand



Quick Blade



Safe Camp



Salve Vial



Skirmish Bow



Spark Touch



Spark Ward



Spear



Tempo Break



Trail Bow

Road Wisdom

A practical play guide

Protect action economy

Use Bonus Actions before attacks: Grit Mend, Inner Flare, Quarry Brand, then hit.

Do not drift apart

The party survives better when healers can reach unconscious allies.

Respect opportunity attacks

If an enemy is adjacent, Disengage before walking away.

Recover between fights

Safe Camp is not just flavor; it restores the resources that win the next encounter.

Use the idol first

If anyone is dead, Pharhad Idol before Safe Camp.

Restart from save

After Game Over, choose Restart From Save to load the last autosave when one exists.